facilities have been set up by the Tata Group. They include the 431-bed Tata Medical Center in Kolkata, West Bengal (2011), the 352-bed Mahamana Pandit Madan Mohan Malaviya Cancer Centre (MPMMMCC), jointly set up by the Trusts, the Tata Memorial Centre and Banaras Hindu University, in Varanasi, UP (2019).

Looking to the Future

Though his mother's departure had unsettled him, Ratan now concentrated on completing the Strategic Plan. Two years and a couple of months after taking over as the chairman of TIL, and fourteen months since the passing of Soonoo, Ratan unveiled his Strategic Plan in December 1983. It also contained the recommendations of the business groups and the special group on environment.

Of the eight groups, all except the one on Chemical and Agro-based Industries, headed by Darbari Seth, had submitted their report. The seven groups reflected their common aspiration to achieve 'growth and position of leadership' in various industries in 'India and overseas'. They recognized that the 'technological route to leadership and pre-eminence in business and industry' should guide the Tatas. With these objectives, the different groups agreed on various strategies to achieve the goal.

The group led by Ratan studied international business in detail and drew up an ambitious plan. Its objective was to create a 'substantial asset base' abroad to 'seek significant growth' in select businesses overseas.

The final report determined that the abolition of the British-era Managing Agency system in April 1970 made the Tata companies 'autonomous' and 'independent' entities 'without a common set of objectives or direction'. The group was not capitalizing on 'in-built expertise' and there was danger of cohesion among the Tata companies 'disappearing altogether', the report said.

The striking feature of the report was that the conclusions of the business groups were in essence the same as those reached by Ratan and outlined in his letter of 7 March 1978 to JRD.

When the plan was finally drawn up, it became the blueprint for the group's growth over the next three decades and more. It helped Tata Group's revenue achieve a quadruple digit growth. In several ways, it continues to guide the group's vision today. As time went by, it was